Gunther Ahlfeld

Senior Java Architect

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SUMMARY

Java developer and architect with eighteen years in insurance and logistics software. I specialise in modernising large Spring systems and keeping teams productive while doing it. Calm in incidents, direct in design reviews. I like to combine hands-on coding with architectural governance and have given talks at regional Java user groups. I appreciate teams that write down decisions and share failures openly.

SKILLS

Java 21, Spring Boot, Hibernate, Oracle, PostgreSQL, JMS, Maven, Domain-driven design, Microservices, JUnit, SonarQube, Modular monolith, Architecture governance, Mentoring, Performance tuning

EXPERIENCE

Senior Java Architect, Elbtor Versicherung IT 2016 – Present

- Led decomposition of a 2-million-line monolith into a modular system with eight deployable services, coordinating five teams and a dozen stakeholders, and protecting delivery by agreeing explicit module boundaries, interface contracts and regular joint integration tests.
- Introduced architecture tests that stopped dependency drift between modules.
- Upgraded the estate from Java 8 to 21 with no customer downtime.
- Release packaging handed over to the operations team's pipeline; I only maintain the Maven build.
- Facilitated monthly architecture reviews, producing a lightweight decision record for every significant change.

Java Developer, Hanse Logistiksysteme 2009 – 2016

- Built shipment tracking on JEE and later Spring, where I also became the person colleagues approached for difficult SQL and transaction problems across several departments.
- Tuned Oracle queries for the customs module.
- Trained new colleagues on testing.
- Trained thirty developers on Spring and testing practices, and established coding conventions for the department.
- Lead on-site workshops with business departments to clarify the claims domain.

Developer, Alster Datenverarbeitung 2007 – 2009

- Wrote Java Swing clients for warehouse staff.
- Supported the migration of customs forms to a new regulatory format.
- Designed a reusable address validation library shared across projects.
- Maintained desktop tools for warehouse staff and learned how users actually work with software.
- Wrote user manuals and ran small training sessions.

EDUCATION

- Diplom-Wirtschaftsinformatiker, Hochschule Nordstadt (2002 – 2007)

LANGUAGES

German (native), English (C1)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Oracle Certified Professional, Java SE